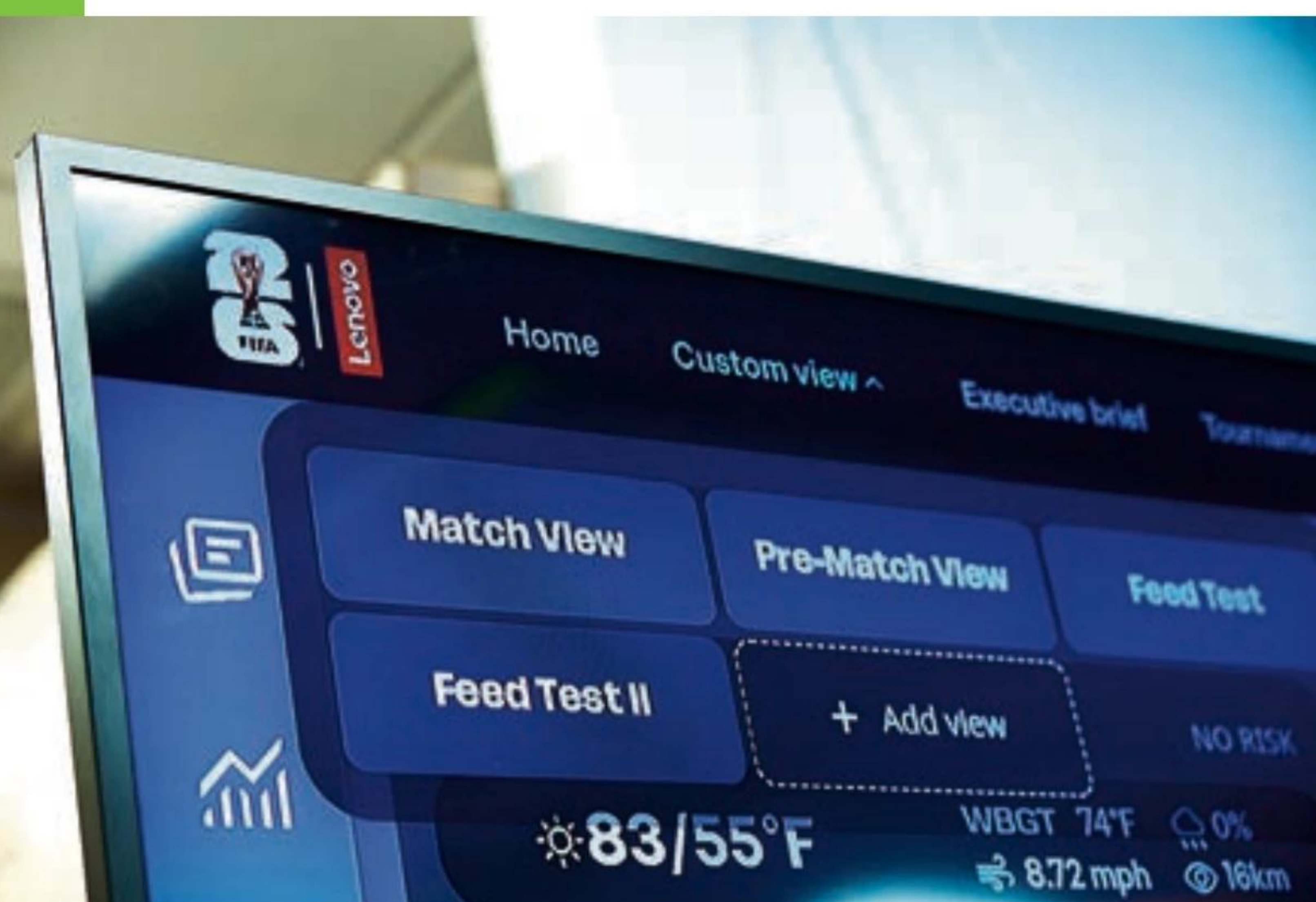




Joint development: Lenovo engineers worked alongside FIFA analysts, coaches and operational staff for more than 18 months, refining ideas and adapting systems to the realities of the world's biggest sporting event. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Decision transparency: FIFA and Lenovo hope greater transparency will at least help supporters understand how decisions are reached. The technology has already attracted interest from other sporting bodies looking to replicate similar systems in their own competitions. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

lightning forced a delay of almost two hours, creating the first major weather disruption of the tournament. Organisers had to manage crowd safety, venue operations, transport logistics and communications while complying with strict American lightning protocols. Rather than relying solely on manual coordination, officials could monitor and manage the response through a single integrated platform, while fans inside the stadium were kept informed and alerted via the official FIFA app.

"They don't have to call probably 30 teams and say, here is your next action item," Sheikh says. "The command centre actually automatically does all the next steps for them. Every venue is connected, every traffic system is connected, every weather system is connected. The command centre is our biggest product that has changed and revolutionised the entire game, the